Web Development Mid-Term Project

CSS Enhancement & Design Decisions Write-up

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LIVE WEBSITE LINK (GITHUB PAGES):
https://devaka207.github.io/resume-website/

GITHUB REPOSITORY LINK:
https://github.com/devaka207/resume-website

1. Executive Summary & Objective

The objective of this assignment was to apply modern CSS fundamentals to transform an initial semantic HTML personal resume into an executive-grade, fully responsive portfolio website. The site showcases my professional journey as an AI FinTech Founder & Product Strategist (Founder & CEO @ FinnDot, Ex-CEO @ Anomapro - acquired by Watad Group, Ex-Product Manager @ Chara, and IIM Bangalore FinTech alumnus). The implementation centers on establishing high visual hierarchy, responsive grid positioning, custom CSS variables, and fluid readability across devices.

2. Key Improvements & CSS Concepts Applied

A. Typography & Readability

Integrated Google Fonts (Plus Jakarta Sans for prominent headings and Inter for crisp reading). Used fluid clamp() font sizing, balanced line-heights (1.6), and letter-spacing.

B. Color System & CSS Variables

Defined comprehensive custom properties (:root) for an Executive Tech palette: Deep Slate (#0f172a), Brand Blue (#2563eb), Cyan Accent (#0ea5e9), and soft slate surfaces with WCAG contrast.

C. Sticky Navigation & Blur

Positioned fixed/sticky top navigation (position: sticky; top: 0) with translucent frosted glass (backdrop-filter: blur(12px)), active scroll spy, and animated underline transitions.

D. Flexbox & CSS Grid Structure

Employed Flexbox for navigation alignment, action buttons, and stat counters. Constructed responsive 2 & 3 column card grids using repeat(auto-fit, minmax(...)) for automatic reflow.

3. Efficient CSS Selectors & Architecture

- **Element Selectors:** Applied universal box-sizing reset (*, *::before, *::after { box-sizing: border-box; }) and reset base headings, body text, lists, and inputs to create predictable box modeling.
- **Class Selectors:** Built modular, reusable component classes (.card, .btn, .btn-primary, .badge-pill, .grid-2, .grid-3) ensuring clean maintainability and preventing styling duplication.
- **ID Selectors:** Targeted primary page landmarks (#hero, #about, #ventures, #experience, #skills, #education, #contact) facilitating smooth in-page navigation anchors with offset scroll padding.
- **Attribute & Pseudo-Selectors:** Styled form fields using input[type='email'], hover states (:hover), active navigation (:active, .active-nav), and timeline connectors using ::before and ::after pseudo-elements.

4. Section-by-Section Architecture & Design Decisions

Hero Section (#hero)

Combines a strong personal value statement, quote, and live status badge with an interactive floating Profile Card. Styled with subtle background radial gradients, CSS keyframe pulse animation, and an avatar with multi-stop linear gradients. Call-to-action buttons feature tactile lift on hover (transform: translateY(-2px)).

About & Pillars (#about)

Features a 3-column CSS Grid highlighting core domains: AI FinTech, Fraud Intelligence, and 0-to-1 Product Strategy. Each card incorporates color-tinted SVG icon wrappers, clear typography, and subtle border-color shifts upon mouse hover.

Ventures & Products (#ventures)

Dedicated showcase for flagship initiatives: FinnDot (Active AI FinTech venture), Anomapro (Fraud intelligence company acquired by Watad Group), and Chara Technologies (DeepTech EV mobility). Custom badges (.status-acquired in purple) visually communicate venture outcomes.

Experience Timeline (#experience)

Built a chronological timeline using CSS absolute positioning for circular node markers and a connecting linear-gradient vertical bar (::before). Career roles at FinnDot, Watad Group, Chara, Sirma, and APPZUI are organized with quantitative metrics, tags, and date pills.

Skills & Competencies (#skills)

Presents strategic business development and customer data intelligence using customized progress meters with gradient progress bars. Accompanied by a flex-wrapping tag cloud (.cloud-badge) with interactive pill-shaped hover effects.

Education & Credentials (#education)

Features the prestigious Executive FinTech Programme at IIM Bangalore and B.E. at DSCE Bangalore, accompanied by verified badges for Google Certified Associate Android Developer, MATLAB Onramp, and published scientific research on Assistive Devices.

Contact & Interactive Form (#contact)

A split-column layout providing direct communication pills (Email, LinkedIn, GitHub) alongside a responsive form. Form inputs feature custom focus rings (box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(37,99,235,0.15)) and accessible contrast ratios.

5. Responsive Media Queries & GitHub Hosting

Mobile-First Responsiveness: Implemented three distinct responsive breakpoints using CSS Media Queries: @media (max-width: 992px) collapses side-by-side hero and form layouts; @media (max-width: 768px) transforms the desktop navbar into a slide-down mobile drawer toggle and collapses 2/3 column grids into single-column flows; and @media (max-width: 480px) stacks CTA button clusters and stats vertically for ergonomic mobile tap access.

GitHub Pages Hosting: The repository is configured at https://github.com/devaka207/resume-website and served live via GitHub Pages at https://devaka207.github.io/resume-website/. The repository maintains clean separation between HTML semantic structure (index.html), modular styling (styles.css), and interactive behavior (script.js).

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST & VERIFICATION

[X] Live Link included [X] GitHub Repo included [X] Design decisions explained [X] Responsive CSS validated

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